

Data Retention and Disposal Policy

Effective July 10, 2026 · Owner: Managing Member, Robert Burton (worrellburton@gmail.com) · Reviewed annually and upon material change

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This policy defines how Ledger Louise, LLC (the “Company”) retains and disposes of client and business records on the operations platform it operates for its affiliated law practice, WADR Law PLLC (the “Firm”), in compliance with applicable data privacy laws and, for the Firm’s records, the New York Rules of Professional Conduct. It covers all records held on the platform (application database, file storage, audit logs and backups) and related engagement records, for all clients and users.

2. RETENTION SCHEDULE

RECORD TYPE	RETENTION PERIOD	BASIS
Client matter files and documents	5 years after the matter concludes; longer on the client’s written instruction	Engagement letter, Standard Terms of Engagement
Trust (IOLTA) and billing/financial records	7 years	N.Y. Rules of Professional Conduct 1.15(d)
Engagement letters and electronic-signature records	Duration of the representation + 7 years	Contract and professional-responsibility evidence
Client personal data held in the platform	Duration of the engagement, then per the schedules above	Service delivery; privacy policy
Platform audit logs	7 years	Accountability and incident investigation
Database backups	Age out automatically on the managed provider’s point-in-time-recovery window	Business continuity
Transactional email records	Held by the email provider per its published terms	Delivery assurance

3. DISPOSAL

- **Platform records** are disposed of in two stages: a soft delete (recoverable; excluded from all active use) followed by a hard delete, which is restricted to administrators and recorded in the audit log. Hard-deleted records are snapshotted to a restricted retention archive, and their files are moved to a segregated archive area, where both are retained for the periods above and then purged.

- **Backups** containing deleted data expire automatically at the end of the provider's recovery window; the Firm does not maintain separate long-term copies.
- **Paper records**, where they exist, are cross-cut shredded.

4. DELETION REQUESTS

Clients and users may request deletion of their personal information by writing to worrellburton@gmail.com.

Requests are honored except where retention is required by the schedules above, professional-responsibility rules, or a legal hold; in that event the requester is informed of what was retained and why, and the data is deleted when the obligation lapses.

5. LEGAL HOLDS

When litigation, an investigation, or a regulatory inquiry is pending or reasonably anticipated, disposal of potentially relevant records is suspended until the Managing Member releases the hold in writing.

6. ENFORCEMENT AND REVIEW

The Managing Member owns this policy, approves exceptions in writing, and reviews it at least annually. Disposal actions on the platform are administrator-only and audit-logged; the audit log is the record of enforcement.